Making a Map: Finding My Way Back

The MAP Project

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MAP Project

Objectives:

- Develop reintegration via interagency planning,
- Implement the Check & Connect mentoring model with adjudicated youth,
- Implement a personalized approach to support youth development and transition,
- Conduct a comprehensive evaluation to determine what works, and
- Create a sustainable and replicable model through extensive interagency collaboration

Interagency Partners:

Volunteers of America Minnesota
Amicus
Uplift All Lives™ Real change starts on the inside.
BETTER TOGETHER

RAMSEY COUNTY

- Community Corrections
- Office of Ramsey County Attorney John J. Choi

Minnesota Department of Education

Saint Paul Public Schools
A World of Opportunities

St. Paul Police

Positively Minnesota
Department of Employment and Economic Development

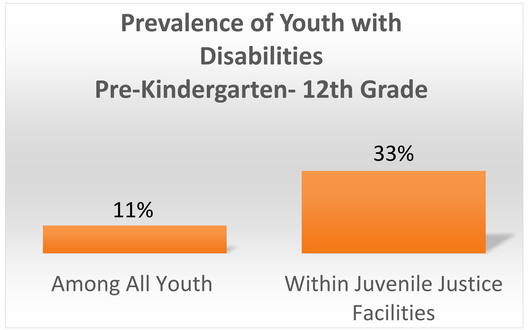
MAP Advisory Team

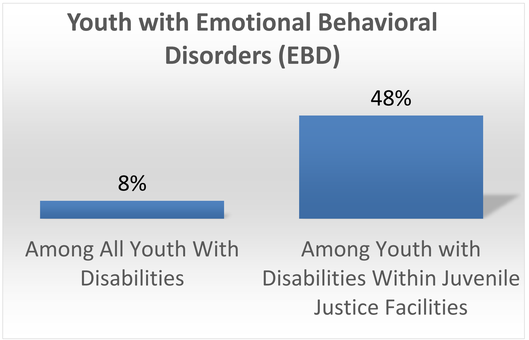
- Includes representatives of interagency partners
- Meets quarterly to support the project

Context

Why MAP is important:

Students with disabilities, especially students with emotional and behavioral disabilities (EBD) are overrepresented in correctional facilities across the U.S. (U.S. Department of Education, 2002; Quinn, Rutherford, Leone, Osher, & Poirier, 2005).



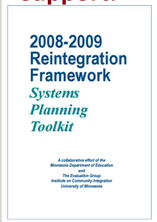


Funding source:

- Demonstration project funded by the U.S. Department of Education, Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP)
- Model Demonstration Projects on Reentry of Students with Disabilities from Juvenile Justice Facilities into Education, Employment, and Community Programs
- Funding period: 2013-2017

MAP Tools

The *Reintegration Toolkit* facilitates reintegration planning by providing a technically-sound process with specific tools that support:

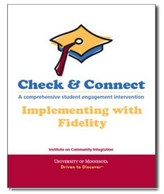


1. Interagency team development;
2. Individual and team needs assessment;
3. Consensus building and priority-setting;
4. Data and resource mapping;
5. Development of action plans focused on needed improvements in system and youth outcomes; and
6. A continuous, outcome-oriented evaluation to monitor progress and guide decision-making

(Minnesota Department of Education and Institute on Community Integration, 2006, NCSET, 2005)

The *Check & Connect* student engagement intervention consists of four components:

1. A **mentor** who works with students and families for at least 2 years



2. Regular **checks** on students' school attendance, behavior, and grades
3. Timely **connect** interventions, driven by data, to reestablish and maintain the student's connection to school and learning and to enhance the student's social and academic competencies; and
4. Engagement with **families**

(Christenson, Stout, & Pohl, 2012)

The *Expanding the Circle* transition curriculum has four components:

1. Exploration of youth's interests, aptitudes, and values as they relate to future decision;



2. Specific activities to increase skill development in decision-making, self-advocacy, problem-solving, diversity awareness, goal setting, organization, and communication;
3. Exploration of postsecondary and career options; and
4. Development of a personal profile for the future focused on postsecondary education, employment, and other life goals.

(Ness & Huisken, 2002)

Evaluation

Evaluation Advisory Committee:

A sub-committee of the MAP Advisory Team

- Will provide input to phases 2 and 3 of the evaluation process
- Includes interagency representatives from the MAP Advisory Team

Formative Evaluation Approach:

Phase 1

- What challenges have been encountered?
- What adaptations need to be made?

Phase 2

- How does the MAP Project work?
- How is it perceived by external stakeholders?

Phase 3

- Common youth outcomes regarding recidivism, high school completion, post-secondary enrollment, and employment as required by OSEP
- Other outcomes as determined by evaluation advisory committee

Current Status

- Focus area from reintegration framework process: ***Supporting Life Skills***
- 34 youth in the program
- 2 referral sites (Boys Totem Town and Ramsey County Juvenile Detention Center)
- 12 active MAP Interagency Advisory members
- Most common interventions:
  - ➢ Teaching problem-solving skills
  - ➢ Discuss behavior and supports
  - ➢ Discuss academic progress
  - ➢ Intensive problem-solving with students
  - ➢ Facilitate goal setting